Cultivating Creativity Through Composition

5 day adult summer camp, 2020

Objectives:

1. *Accessing our innate creativity*
    - *Letting go of perfectionism*
    - *Incorporate free improvisation into practice routine (5-10 minutes)*
    - *Read Artist's Way by Julia Cameron (optional)*
        - *Daily morning pages — a journaling activity that helps to discover the artist within*
        - *Artist's Date — a date with yourself where you do an activity you have wanted to do, but haven't. (ex: paint a mug, write a poem, go to a new place)*
2. *Compose and record 1 or more compositions*
3. *Learn compositional/improvisational strategies*
4. *Network and make new friends*
5. *Private video concert and party*

This camp is open to all adult students (ages 18-90) who play saxophone or flute and have an interest in composition. *No previous experience with composition or improvisation is required.* These sessions will cover the fundamental aspects of composition and will provide an opportunity for students to learn notational and recording software. There will be time at the end of each session for questions.

Cost: $200

Guest artist: Andrew Bishop is a versatile saxophonist, clarinetist, flautist, composer, improviser, educator, and scholar comfortable in many musical idioms. Dave Lynch of All Media Guide wrote, "A composer of contemporary orchestral and chamber music, Bishop combines a jazzman's fire and flow with a rigorous compositional sensibility, resulting in a potent and highly satisfying blend." He maintains an active national and international career and serves as an associate professor and chair of University of Michigan Department of Jazz and Contemporary Improvisation in Ann Arbor where he teaches applied jazz saxophone, composition, and improvisation.

Camp Instructor: Meg received her Bachelors in Flute Performance and Jazz Saxophone from Michigan State University. Currently, she is pursuing her Masters in Music at the University of Michigan under the direction of Andrew Bishop. At the age of 16, she was accepted into the internationally renowned Interlochen Arts Academy High School where she studied under classical and jazz flutist, Nancy Stagnitta. During her time at Michigan State University, she had the opportunity to play with jazz artists like Christian McBride, Kenny Barron, Peter Bernstein, Rodney Whitaker, Jimmy Cobb, Anat Cohen, and Roy Hargrove. An active performer in Detroit, she has played at the Fox Theater, Cliff Bells, Ford Field, Baker's Keyboard Lounge, and The Whitney. In addition to her performing career, Meg is dedicated composer and educator. She is working on her first album and plans to release it in 2020.

Camp Schedule

sessions are 11am - noon

DAY 1 Tuesday, June 30th

Meet & Greet

- talk about the purpose of this camp
- Introduction to notational software (Noteflight or Finale Notepad) OR writing music on manuscript paper
    - *Assignment:*
        1. *Compose 8-12 bar solo melody for your instrument (optional)*

DAY 2 Thursday, July 2nd

Intro to composition

- How to create a melody (*ideas for a blank page*)
- How to develop harmony or use pre-existing harmony that supports your melody
- How to develop song structure: ex: intro, main melody, bridge, main melody, outro
- Discuss final project: project should involve 2 or more instruments

    - *Weekend Assignment:*
        2. *Compose a secondary line for day 1's melody, making it a duet (optional)*
        3. *Begin final project*
        4. *Go on an artist date - optional* (See above ^)*

DAY 3 Tuesday, July 7th

Check in/Guest Artist

- Discuss options for recording duets
- Q & A with Andrew Bishop (*Bring your composition questions)*

    - *Assignment:*
        - *Record duets*
        - *Finish writing/recording final project*

DAY 4 Thursday, July 9th

The Final Touches

- Share artist date experiences
- Time for individual help

    - *Assignment:*
        - *Record final project*
        - *Send recordings of your duet and final project to Meg (all participants recordings will be compiled for the final video)*

DAY 5 Friday, July 10th

Watch Party — Weather permitting, we could potentially have the party at an outdoor park.